

Marketing and Market Research

International Business

Projects



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Module Convenor - Dr Arne Floh



Personal Information

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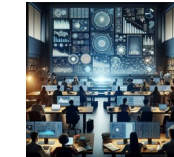
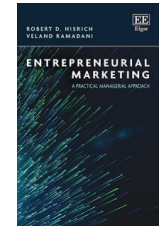
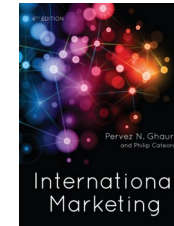
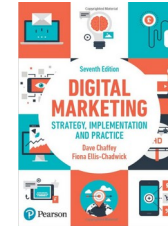
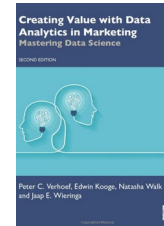
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Module Convenor - Dr Arne Floh



- Work Experience
 - International & Industry Background
 - Teaching Experience > 25 Years
- Teaching
 - International Marketing
 - International Business Projects
 - Marketing Research and Marketing Analytics
 - Global Branding
 - Supervision (BSc, MSc, PhD)
- Research
 - Dynamic Capabilities and Firm Performance
 - GenAI and Marketing
 - SMEs and Internationalization
- Private
 - Football
 - Electronic Gadgets
 - Austrian Wine



Course synopsis



Capstone-style course for students specializing in International Business



Core task: develop a comprehensive international marketing plan



Marketing and marketing research at the core: investigate markets systematically and evaluate opportunities and risks



Emphasis on critical thinking, project management and teamwork in a multicultural context



Outcome: a structured international marketing plan with evidence-based strategic recommendations

Learning objectives



Research & analysis

- Conduct and interpret marketing research for evidence-based decisions
- Analyze competition, customer needs and cultural influences



Strategy & planning

- Design and present a structured international marketing plan based on systematic analysis and research
- Apply marketing concepts internationally and evaluate opportunities and risks across markets
- Develop creativity and problem-solving to propose innovative, feasible strategies



Teamwork & communication

- Strengthen teamwork, project management and intercultural collaboration
- Communicate complex ideas clearly and persuasively, in writing and orally

Teaching and learning: flipped classroom

Before class



- Independent research on key concepts and methods
- Preparation for the next session's task
- Self-directed learning



In class



- Discussion and application
- Coaching sessions and progress reports
- Peer feedback
- Theory directly connected to the project task

The Julius Meinl case



Marketing plan for entering Latin America

Our partner: Julius Meinl

1862

family-owned Viennese coffee roaster, now in its fifth generation

70+

countries: mostly through local distribution partners

2

segments per market:
hospitality and grocery retail

Positioning: Viennese coffee house culture rather than the bean itself, meaning service, hospitality and the idea of taking time for a cup of coffee



How Julius Meinl sells: two segments, two partners

Hospitality (HoReCa)



- Cafés, restaurants and hotels
- The primary segment: hotels matter most, with breakfast and bar business
- A dedicated partner, because hotels and grocery chains are different businesses

Grocery retail



- Coffee for the home, through grocery chains and delicatessen
- Premium assortment
- A dedicated partner: with no own sales organisation in export markets, the partner is the sales force

Who Julius Meinl sells to

Hospitality

Hotels with breakfast and bar service, especially with international guests; premium restaurants and cafés; venues where coffee is part of a quality experience

Retail

Grocery and delicatessen with a premium assortment; shoppers who can pay a premium price; places where brands such as illy are already on the shelf

Less relevant

Venues and retailers competing on price, and areas without purchasing power

The question: growth in Latin America

Julius Meinl sees Latin America (South America and Mexico) as a potential future growth region, where it is currently not present or only marginally.



- 1 Which Latin American markets are attractive?
- 2 How could market entry look?
- 3 How should the brand be marketed?

Central question: Many Latin American countries grow and roast their own coffee and have a strong coffee culture. Why would cafés, hotels, retailers and consumers choose a coffee brand from Vienna, and who exactly would do so?

Six markets, one set of criteria

Markets compared by all groups



Simplified outlines, not to scale

Example criteria

- Size of the premium coffee segment (HoReCa and retail)
- Tourism and international hotel presence
- Purchasing power and economic development
- Competitive landscape
- Import conditions and regulation
- Coffee culture and consumption habits

Assessment strategy



Three group presentations, self-reflection and peer review

Overview of the presentations

Presentation	Length	Weight	Focus
1 Content presentation	15 min	20 %	Market selection tools: theory, real-world applications, pitfalls
2 Midterm presentation	20 min	30 %	Market selection and competitor analysis
3 Final presentation	25 min	30 %	Marketing implementation plan

Presentation 1: market selection tools

1 Content

15 min · 20 %

2 Midterm

20 min · 30 %

3 Final

25 min · 30 %

- Review the tools companies use to screen, compare and select international markets
- Cover the theory, real-world applications and typical pitfalls (e.g., data availability, subjective weighting, outdated indicators)
- Recommend the tool best suited to compare the six Latin American markets for Julius Meinl
- Format: max. 15 minutes and 15 slides, information-rich with clear visualizations
- Document all sources in a separate Excel sheet

Presentation 2: midterm

1 Content

15 min · 20 %

2 Midterm

20 min · 30 %

3 Final

25 min · 30 %

Part A: Market selection

- Compare the six countries using the same criteria
- Apply the tool chosen in the content presentation, transparently and replicably
- Rank the countries and justify the ranking
- Discuss the sensitivity of the ranking to criteria and weights
- Submit one Excel file and one presentation file; end with a justified recommendation

Part B: Market and competitor analysis

- Deep-dive into the assigned country
- Out-of-home and at-home coffee consumption
- Premium brands present and their prices
- Distribution in HoReCa and retail; import conditions
- Competitor positioning and communication
- Online analysis of the target city (menus, shelf prices, reviews, social media)

Presentation 3: marketing implementation plan

1 Content

15 min · 20 %

2 Midterm

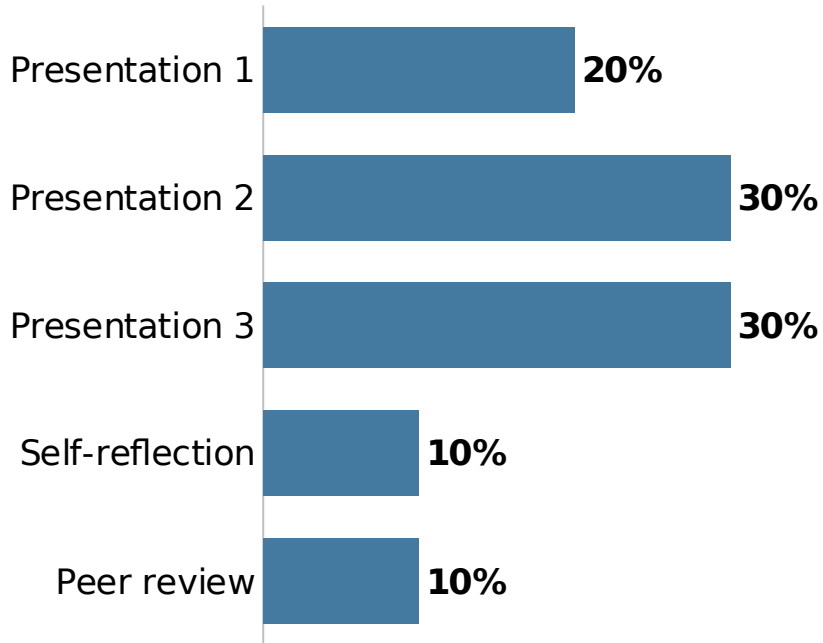
20 min · 30 %

3 Final

25 min · 30 %

- Market entry and marketing plan for the assigned market: how the brand is marketed and how Julius Meinl enters the market
 - Target segment and first customers
 - Positioning, incl. the answer to the central question
 - Price positioning vs. competition
 - Distribution via a local partner, incl. a profile of a suitable partner
 - Communication and in-market activation (incl. creative implementation)
 - Rough timeline, first-year KPIs and key risks
- Format: max. 25 minutes

Grade components



Grading scale

- 1 (90-100 %)
- 2 (80-89 %)
- 3 (70-79 %)
- 4 (51-69 %)
- 5 (0-50 %)

Teaching schedule

Session 1

Course content and logistics

→ Prepare content presentation

Session 2

Content presentation

→ Country comparison, selection model

Session 3

Coaching session, progress report

→ Refinement and revision

Session 4

Coaching session, progress report

→ Prepare midterm presentation

Session 5

Midterm presentation

→ Assigned market, marketing plan

Session 6

Coaching session, progress report

→ Refinement and revision

Session 7

Coaching session, progress report

→ Prepare final presentation

Session 8

Final presentation

→ Self-reflection, peer review

Data sources and framework conditions

Framework conditions

- The project is based on publicly available data
- Julius Meinl provides no internal figures (revenues, margins, prices, partner names); none are needed
- When contacting companies or individuals, act as students on a university project, not on behalf of Julius Meinl

Possible sources

- USDA coffee country reports
- Coffee import trade statistics
- National tourism statistics
- Public Julius Meinl material (corporate story, sustainability report, website)

AI, self-reflection and peer review

Use of AI



- Use of (Generative) AI tools is explicitly encouraged
- Tell a rich story in your presentations
- Be honest: list all tools you used
- Graded on quality, innovativeness and variety of sources

Self-reflection and peer review



- Self-reflection: one page on what you learned, what you liked and what can be improved
- Peer review: rate the engagement and performance of your group mates (not yourself); kept confidential
- Submit via Canvas until one week after the last session



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